FREE PRINTABLE · MICRO & DESTINATION WEDDINGS

Wedding Planning Checklist by Month

What to do from 12+ months out to the big day. Tick as you go, and write a target month next to each stage.

Theodore Creates Co.
DIGITAL PLANNERS & TEMPLATES

WEDDING DATE _____

WHERE _____

12+ MONTHS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Set your total budget & who is contributing
- [ ] Choose the destination & season (check weather & local holidays)
- [ ] Decide: legal ceremony abroad, or legal at home + ceremony abroad
- [ ] Draft the guest list (who truly must be there?)
- [ ] Research venues & ask about availability
- [ ] Book a local planner or coordinator
- [ ] Book the venue & lock in your date

9–11 MONTHS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Send save-the-dates with the travel window & nearest airport
- [ ] Build a wedding website / travel guide for guests
- [ ] Reserve a hotel room block or villa
- [ ] Book photographer / videographer
- [ ] Book your officiant
- [ ] Check passports (valid 6+ months after travel)
- [ ] Buy travel insurance that covers the wedding
- [ ] Start shopping for wedding attire

NOTES

6–8 MONTHS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Book caterer (if not included with the venue)
- [ ] Book florist & décor
- [ ] Book music / DJ
- [ ] Book hair & makeup
- [ ] Book your flights
- [ ] Book the honeymoon
- [ ] Order attire & plan fittings around travel
- [ ] Plan the welcome party & guest airport transfers

4–5 MONTHS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Send invitations (RSVP deadline about 10 weeks out)
- [ ] Order wedding rings
- [ ] Request birth certificates & documents the country needs
- [ ] Get apostilles & certified translations (if needed)
- [ ] Plan guest activities & excursions
- [ ] Order welcome bags & favors
- [ ] Menu & cake tasting (or a video call)

NOTES

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The Final Stretch

2–3 months out, the last weeks, the wedding day and after.

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RSVP DEADLINE _____ ROOM BLOCK CUT-OFF _____ FINAL PAYMENTS DUE _____

2–3 MONTHS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Chase missing RSVPs
- [ ] Confirm room-block pickup before the cut-off date
- [ ] Submit marriage paperwork to the local office
- [ ] Write vows & the ceremony running order
- [ ] Send dietary needs & allergies to the caterer
- [ ] Draft the day-of timeline with your planner
- [ ] Get local currency & travel adapters

1 MONTH before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Final dress / suit fitting
- [ ] Make the seating plan
- [ ] Confirm every vendor in writing (times, addresses)
- [ ] Pay final balances
- [ ] Send guests their itinerary & transfer times
- [ ] Prepare vendor tips in labeled envelopes
- [ ] Print signs, menus & place cards

1–2 WEEKS before

TARGET _____

- [ ] Give the final headcount to venue & caterer
- [ ] Pack: rings & documents in your carry-on
- [ ] Share a day-of contact sheet with the wedding party
- [ ] Break in your wedding shoes

NOTES

FINAL DAYS

TARGET _____

- [ ] Online check-in & download boarding passes
- [ ] Arrive 3–5 days early
- [ ] Venue walk-through with your planner
- [ ] Marriage / registry appointment (if legal abroad)
- [ ] Drop welcome bags at the hotel
- [ ] Rehearsal or welcome drinks
- [ ] Rest, hydrate & get an early night

WEDDING DAY

TARGET _____

- [ ] Eat breakfast (really!)
- [ ] Rings & vows to the officiant / best person
- [ ] Tip envelopes to your coordinator
- [ ] Sign the marriage certificate

AFTER

TARGET _____

- [ ] Return rentals & settle final bills
- [ ] Order certified copies of the certificate
- [ ] Register the marriage back home (if required)
- [ ] Start name-change paperwork
- [ ] Send thank-you notes
- [ ] Leave reviews for your vendors

NOTES

Want this done for you, with real dates?

The full Micro & Destination Wedding Planner (Excel + Google Sheets, 18 tabs) dates all 67 tasks from your wedding day and flags overdue ones, plus a two-currency budget, guest list & RSVPs with travel and rooms, room-block tracker, vendors, payments, legal paperwork abroad, packing list and a live dashboard.

Get the full planner on Etsy →